

public assistance receives in a month.” How can you pay for either a child or an abortion?

There are some abortion financial resources out there. Noel Leon works for the DC Abortion Fund, which provides money for people looking to get abortions. Before talking to Noel, I had no idea about the existence of abortion funds—nonprofit organizations that provide grants for those (largely low-income) people who need small amounts of money to pay for abortions. People call, tell the fund how much they believe they can cover and how much they need, and they are granted the money if they are eligible. There are funds like this all over the country. “To date, we have never turned away a single person who was eligible for DCAF funding,” the DC Abortion Fund said on its website.

DCAF fundraises all the time, but because of limited resources, it can’t afford to always meet a patient’s full need. Sometimes, Noel said, the volunteers give callers suggestions like asking ten friends for \$20. That’s \$200 extra. This is very idealistic, in my opinion, to assume that someone has ten friends with money to spare or that there are ten people they’d trust with their private medical information.

Noel said people are often terrified when calling the fund and apologize profusely for asking for money. They feel ashamed of needing an abortion and of needing financial assistance to do so, though that’s the fund’s job. The stigma runs deep.

When people call, Noel asks them their income, their job situation, what insurance they have, how many people live in their home, and some other questions. At first she thought these questions were too personal, but then she realized that lower-income people are used to sharing this kind of information with strangers: they often have to answer what a higher-income person might consider invasive to receive government assistance. Rich people are the ones who don’t want to talk about money, she theorized, but poor people do it all the time. (This is illustrated perfectly in an incredible *New York Times* article, “What the Rich Won’t Tell You,” which you should read right now.)

Even in places where abortion isn’t harshly regulated, it is not always accessible. Sometimes the clinic is far away and the person can’t figure out how